Equal Opportunity Policy

POL-005 | Version V2

Document Control

Policy ID	POL-005
Policy Name	Equal Opportunity Policy
Category	Human Resources
Department	Human Resources
Version	V2
Effective Date	2026-06-15
Status	Superseded

1. Purpose

This policy establishes fair and consistent employment practices and prohibits unlawful discrimination in employment decisions. The organization is committed to ensuring that employment opportunities are administered using documented, objective, and job-related criteria.

2. Scope

This policy applies to employees, managers, supervisors, HR personnel, applicants, and other individuals involved in employment decisions. It covers recruitment, selection, promotion, compensation, training, performance management, disciplinary action, and termination.

3. Definitions

Protected characteristics and other prohibited grounds are characteristics or circumstances that must not be used as an unlawful basis for an employment decision. Objective criteria are documented, job-related considerations that can reasonably be used to evaluate an employment decision.

4. Policy Requirements

Employment decisions must be made fairly and consistently. Managers must use documented objective, job-related criteria and must not base decisions on protected characteristics or other prohibited grounds.

For recruitment and selection, managers must document the approved selection criteria before evaluating candidates. Where practical, comparable candidates must be assessed against the same approved criteria.

HR will periodically review employment decision processes to determine whether approved criteria are being applied consistently and whether potential unequal outcomes require further examination.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

Managers are responsible for applying approved and documented employment criteria consistently and retaining supporting decision records. HR is responsible for maintaining procedures that support fair employment practices, reviewing employment decision processes periodically, and advising managers when concerns are raised.

Employees may raise concerns about discriminatory treatment through the organization's grievance or HR investigation process.

6. Records and Evidence

Recruitment and employment records must contain sufficient information to demonstrate that decisions followed approved organizational criteria. For recruitment and selection decisions, supporting records should identify the criteria applied and provide sufficient evidence of how the decision was reached.

Records must be maintained in accordance with applicable record-retention requirements.

7. Exceptions and Escalation

Concerns about discriminatory treatment must be escalated through the grievance or HR investigation process. Reports must be handled confidentially to the extent reasonably possible.

Where an employment decision cannot be supported by the approved criteria or supporting records are incomplete, the matter must be referred to HR for review.

8. Monitoring and Review

HR will conduct periodic reviews of employment decision processes to identify potential concerns relating to unequal treatment. Reviews may consider recruitment, promotion, compensation, training, performance management, disciplinary action, and termination practices.

Where a concern is identified, HR may recommend corrective or preventive action and may require additional documentation or process review.

9. Related Policies and Controls

This policy should be read together with applicable grievance, disciplinary, recruitment, employee conduct, record-management, and HR investigation policies.

10. Version Change Summary

Version 2 adds documented objective selection criteria, supporting evidence requirements, periodic review of employment decision processes, and HR escalation where decisions cannot be adequately supported.

11. Document Control

Policy Owner: Human Resources Approval Authority: Human Resources Management Review Cycle: Periodic review by HR Version Review Date: 2026-06-15